collective history and how the Kabaili[6] tribesmen raided, burnt and looted Gulmarg and other parts of the Kashmir Valley.

During the summer of 1966, I met Dr Karan Singh and his now-deceased wife Yasho Rajya Lakshmi for the first time when they attended a dinner at our house in Delhi's Aurangzeb Road. Dr Singh is Maharaja Hari Singh's son and the former Governor of Jammu and Kashmir. They are, of course, Uncle Tiger and Aunty Asha for me. They were an elegant and sophisticated couple and I vividly remember being moved on hearing Dr Singh sing some Punjabi and Dogri songs, while the dinner guests sipped coffee from the family's Rosenthal china.

In February 1970, when my grandfather passed away, Uncle Tiger was one of the first mourners to visit our house. Over the next 50 years, as the next generation of the Kashmir royal family came of age, my wife Anu and I have enjoyed a warm friendship with each of the members.

As a documentary film producer, I once met Dr Karan Singh for a project in 2013 at his then office at the Nehru Memorial Trust in Teen Murti Bhavan, New Delhi. When I started talking about producing a documentary on what he believed had gone wrong in Jammu and Kashmir, he grew cautious. He started speaking in chaste Punjabi since no one else present would be able to fathom the nuance and idiom of the language. It was a language that was spoken by very few people on the Indian side of the border. He felt that if he revealed the truth, it would cause significant tremors in Raisina Hill[7]. He wanted to carry his secrets to the grave.

In 2014, Discovery Channel commissioned two hour-long feature documentaries from my company, AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.
These were called *Revealed: Line of Control* and *1965: Heroes and Battles.* Maroof Raza, my co-author, was the consultant on both these films. The popularity of these two films encouraged Discovery to commission another documentary called *Revealed: Siachen* from us. This film provided insight into the real reason behind the sustained pressure from the Sino-Pakistan forces on the Indian state. This was the war for water and the important military advantage that the Siachen Glacier and the Shaksgam Valley enjoy.